

Special Notice (SN) ARPA-H-SN-26-152
Proposers' Day Announcement for Advanced Research Projects Agency for Health
(ARPA-H)/Health Science Futures (HSF) Office
Opportunity: One Comprehensive Universal Radiotherapy for Everyone (1-CURE)

I. KEY INFORMATION

Table 1. Proposers' Day Key Information	
Proposers' Day	03/24, 2026 from 8:30 AM to 12:30 PM CT (Main event) 03/24, 2026 from 1:30 PM to 3:30 PM CT (Lightning talks)
Location	Hybrid (In Person and Online) Helix Park, Houston, Texas
Website for registration	https://solutions.arpa-h.gov/1-CURE/
Registration opens	03/16, 2026, at 10:00 AM ET
Registration closes	03/23, 2026, at 12:00 PM ET
Technical Point of Contact	Dr. Wilfred Ngwa, Program Manager, ARPA-H / HSF Office
Program email	1-CURE@arpa-h.gov
Proposer deliverables, details below	1) Provide one (1) page slide for a 3-minute lighting talk 2) One (1) PDF page "teaming profile" (proposer's capabilities, composition, research areas of interest, etc.)

II. INTRODUCTION

This Special Notice (SN) is intended to alert the scientific community to a newly approved ARPA-H Program and notify potential proposers of an associated Proposers' Day (PD). Under the cognizance of HSF, ARPA-H is publishing an Innovative Solutions Opening (ISO) for the 1-CURE program no later than **March 16, 2026**.

The Health Science Futures (HSF) Office of the Advanced Research Projects Agency for Health (ARPA-H) is sponsoring a **Proposers' Day (PD)** for the planned proposer community in support of the 1-CURE program.

Potential proposers are encouraged to attend the optional Proposers' Day. While not mandatory, ARPA-H is hosting the 1-CURE PD to achieve the following objectives:

- Draw attention of the scientific community to the 1-CURE technical areas.
- Provide information about the program to potential proposers, including details about the overall program goals, solution summary, and full proposal structure

for the forthcoming Innovative Solutions Opening (ISO), and how they might respond to ARPA-H's forthcoming ISO.

- Share the intended scope, timeline, and scale of the 1-CURE program and how the proposers, in collaboration with the ARPA-H team and resources, can accomplish the collective mission of accelerating healthcare outcomes for all Americans.
- Promote teaming arrangements among potential proposers to achieve program goals.

The PD will include brief overview presentations by government personnel; three (3)-minute *lightning talks* for potential proposers highlighting technical capabilities and promoting teaming arrangements; and five (5)-minute private sidebar meetings between the ARPA-H team and potential proposers. A limited number of sidebar meetings will be available to participants, and sidebar meetings **must** be scheduled via the registration website. ARPA-H will collect participant questions throughout the event and publish answers to a publicly available Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) and on [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov).

Attendance at this event is **not** a requirement for submission of a solution summary, full proposal, or selection for funding; however, it is anticipated that unique multi-party teaming arrangements will be needed to successfully innovate and integrate the critical technologies necessary to meet the 1-CURE program goals. Information relayed during the PD will be made available on the HSF Office section of the ARPA-H Opportunities page: [Open Funding Opportunities | ARPA-H](#) as well as [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov).

Advance Registration is required. Registration requests will only be accepted from the potential proposer community as participation is not intended for patients, patient advocates, media or a general interest audience.

III. 1-CURE- PROGRAM INFORMATION

While full details of the 1-CURE program will be provided in the forthcoming 1-CURE ISO, the following is a brief description of the full program. Proposers should refer to the forthcoming 1-CURE ISO for more details.

Overview

Cancer remains a leading cause of death in the USA and worldwide. The goal of the 1-CURE program is to develop a revolutionary radiotherapy (RT) approach effective against all cancers with a single, rapid, and low-cost treatment. The 1-CURE approach involves integrating ultra-high dose rate (FLASH)-RT technology with multifunctional immunogenic smart radiotherapy biomaterials (SRBs). These SRBs will provide image-guided targeting and sustained immunoadjuvant delivery to boost the abscopal effect during RT, an effect which causes regression of both local and metastatic

tumors. The strategy involves using ablative FLASH-RT to generate neoantigens during RT for any cancer, to effectively prime the abscopal effect bolstered by targeted sustained immunoadjuvant delivery from the SRBs to overcome resistance and immunosuppression with minimal toxicities. Transformative innovations will enable the integrated use of FLASH-RT with the immunogenic SRBs to revolutionize cancer care with a universal curative treatment approach, substantially reducing mortality and improving curative rates while saving over \$170B annually for the U.S. alone.

Technical Approach

The 1-CURE program is divided into two main technical areas (TAs) implemented in three phases.

Technical Area 1 (TA1): Immunogenic Nanoparticle SRBs:

The overall program objective for TA1 is to develop multi-functional immunogenic nanoparticle SRBs that can be used for different cancers. Potential approaches/technologies include but are not limited to innovations involving theranostic high-atomic number nanomaterials that can provide both Computed Tomography (CT) and Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) contrast; use of polymer materials that make tumors more immunogenic, e.g., Poly(lactic-co-glycolic acid) (PLGA) or phospholipid systems like those used in COVID-19 vaccines; leveraging Click Chemistry for preparing, loading or functionalizing with synergistic immunoadjuvants and with targeting moieties. Examples of immunoadjuvants may include STING (Stimulator of Interferon Genes) agonists, anti-CD40, GMCSF (Granulocyte-macrophage colony-stimulating factor), check-point inhibitors, and other immunomodulators.

Technical Area 2 (TA2): Establish Abscopal Treatment Planning System (ATPS) for Low-cost FLASH-RT with immunogenic nanoparticle SRBs:

The overall program objectives for TA2 are to develop an ATPS to generate predictable effective treatment plans integrating use of optimal FLASH-RT parameters (dose, field size, tumor type, etc.) with immunogenic nanoparticle SRBs parameters (immunoadjuvant type/dose, nanoparticle size, etc.). Options for achieving this may include but are not limited to upgrading or developing new RT treatment planning algorithms that incorporate immune response models and data on biomarkers or immune cell populations, e.g., T-Cells, RT and synergistic immunoadjuvant dose, space-time distribution of nanoparticle SRBs, or the use of AI-based approaches and other approaches.

Proposal Option

Applicants must submit comprehensive proposals to address both TA1 and TA2.

IV. 1-CURE - PROPOSERS' DAY INFORMATION

Proposers' Day Participation and Deliverables

This SN and PD include two specific opportunities for prospective proposers to identify team members:

Lightning Talks

Interested attendees are invited to submit one (1) MS Power Point or Adobe PDF slide that summarizes their interests and capabilities. These will be presented to the entire PD audience during the lightning talk portion of the PD. Submitted presentations consisting of multiple slides or a single slide with multiple layers will **not** be granted a time slot. Lightning talk submissions (no more than one per organization) will be accepted on a first-come, first-served basis, until the maximum possible number of submissions (given time constraints) is reached. Interested attendees must identify their intention to submit the lightning talk during registration.

Teaming Profiles

Interested parties are also invited to submit a 'teaming profile' via the link here) (<https://solutions.arpa-h.gov/Teaming>) and below. The teaming profile will describe the technical competencies, team capabilities, team composition, research areas of interest, unique facilities and other capabilities, as they relate to the program, and desired technical/other competencies sought from other potential team partners. The profile will include, at a minimum:

- Contact information, to include name, organization, email, telephone number, mailing address, and website
- Brief description of the proposer's technical competencies and relevant facilities
- Desired technical competencies and facilities from other potential team members, if applicable

All teaming profiles must be submitted via the 1-CURE Teaming Profile Form Link (<https://solutions.arpa-h.gov/Teaming>) The teaming profile will be updated regularly and made available on the program's teaming profile site <https://solutions.arpa-h.gov/Teaming>. Specific content, communications, networking, and team formation are the sole responsibility of participants. ARPA-H does not endorse any participating organization or exercise any responsibility for improper dissemination of the team profiles.

Live Q&A

A live Q&A session will be led by the Business Innovation Division (BID) during 1-CURE PD. Virtual PD participants are encouraged to use this time to discuss any 1-CURE contracting questions you have with our contracting experts. ARPA-H will

collect participants' questions and BID responses and make them available in the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) in <https://solutions.arpa-h.gov/Ask-A-Question/>

Registration Information

Participants must register in advance through the registration website. **PLEASE NOTE:** Registration will remain open until the day of the event. There is no registration fee for the 1-CURE Proposers' Day. **Note that there will be no same-day registration.** An online registration form and various other meeting details can be found at the registration website, <https://solutions.arpa-h.gov/1CURE/>.

All inquiries should be addressed to 1-CURE@arpa-h.gov. Please refer to the 1-CURE Proposers' Day (ARPA-H-SN-24-114) in all correspondence. Prior to submitting an e-mail inquiry, please check the General Program FAQs to see if your question is answered there.

V. POINTS OF CONTACT

Technical Point of Contact

Dr. Wilfred Ngwa, Program Manager, ARPA-H / HSF Office

Email: 1-CURE@arpa-h.gov

All inquiries should reference "1-CURE Proposers' Day (ARPA-H-SN-26-152)" in the subject line of the email.

VI. WEBINAR INFORMATION

Attendees will receive the link to the webinar once they are verified and registration is confirmed.

VII. DISCLAIMER

This SN is issued solely for information and potential new program planning purposes; the SN does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals or solution summaries. Responses to this notice are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding award. Submission of any information in response to the SN is voluntary and is not required to propose to subsequent ARPA-H ISOs or research solicitations on this or any other topic. ARPA-H will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred in responding to this SN. Respondents are advised that ARPA-H is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted under this SN.